

Utrains Company Handbook

Policy year 2026 | Current approved edition

Purpose

This handbook describes approved workplace policies, responsibilities, exceptions, and escalation paths. The current policy repository is authoritative when a policy or plan changes. This document is designed as a realistic source for a retrieval-augmented generation exercise.

Field	Value
Edition	2026.1
Status	Current
Owner	People Operations
Review cycle	Annual or when material changes occur

1. Time Off and Annual Leave

Policy

Employees receive annual leave based on employment status and tenure. Full-time employees receive 20 days per calendar year. Requests should normally be submitted through the HR portal at least five business days before the first day away. Managers respond within two business days.

Exceptions and guidance

Urgent leave, medical leave, and legally protected leave follow separate procedures. The HR Leave Team is the policy owner.

Metadata: source=company_handbook.pdf | section=1 | version=2026.1 | status=current | owner=People Operations

2. Company Holidays

Policy

The company observes ten paid holidays for employees in the United States. Local holiday calendars apply to employees in other countries. The calendar published in the HR portal is the authoritative schedule for the current year.

Exceptions and guidance

Employees working on a company holiday must receive the applicable premium or replacement day under local law and manager approval.

Metadata: source=company_handbook.pdf | section=2 | version=2026.1 | status=current | owner=People Operations

3. Parental Leave

Policy

Full-time employees become eligible for paid parental leave after six months of continuous service. Eligible employees may receive 20 weeks of paid leave for the birth, adoption, or placement of a child.

Exceptions and guidance

The Leave Team confirms eligibility and coordinates statutory leave. Company leave and statutory leave may run concurrently where permitted.

Metadata: source=company_handbook.pdf | section=3 | version=2026.1 | status=current | owner=People Operations

4. Caregiver and Medical Leave

Policy

Employees should contact the Leave Team as soon as they know that a medical or caregiving absence may be needed. Medical information must be sent through the secure leave channel, not ordinary email.

Exceptions and guidance

Clinical decisions belong to qualified providers. Managers should not request a diagnosis or medical details.

Metadata: source=company_handbook.pdf | section=4 | version=2026.1 | status=current | owner=People Operations

5. Health Benefits

Policy

Employees may select individual or family coverage during the annual enrollment window. Current plan costs, deductibles, and specialist copays are published in the benefits portal. Plan HMO-204 has a \$35 specialist copay and PPO-440 has a \$60 specialist copay for the 2026 plan year.

Exceptions and guidance

The benefits portal controls current prices. A handbook answer should cite the plan year and tell the employee when information must be verified.

Metadata: source=company_handbook.pdf | section=5 | version=2026.1 | status=current | owner=People Operations

6. Retirement Savings

Policy

Eligible employees may contribute to the retirement plan through payroll deductions. The company matches 50 percent of employee contributions up to six percent of eligible pay, subject to the plan document and local requirements.

Exceptions and guidance

The plan administrator, not an HR assistant, determines final eligibility and investment information.

Metadata: source=company_handbook.pdf | section=6 | version=2026.1 | status=current | owner=People Operations

7. Travel and Expense Reimbursement

Policy

Employees may book standard rail travel without prior approval when the cost is below USD 250 per trip. Air travel, international travel, and any trip above USD 250 require manager approval before booking. Receipts must be submitted through the expense portal within 30 days.

Exceptions and guidance

A missing receipt requires a written explanation and finance review. Personal upgrades are not reimbursable unless approved as an accessibility accommodation.

Metadata: source=company_handbook.pdf | section=7 | version=2026.1 | status=current | owner=People Operations

8. Remote and Hybrid Work

Policy

Eligible roles may use a hybrid schedule recorded in the team workspace. A manager may require attendance for customer events, training, or operational needs. Remote work from another country requires Legal, Tax, and Security approval before travel.

Exceptions and guidance

A remote arrangement does not change working-hour, security, or data-handling obligations.

Metadata: source=company_handbook.pdf | section=8 | version=2026.1 | status=current | owner=People Operations

9. Compensation Reviews

Policy

The annual compensation review cycle begins in October and is completed by March. Employees may request a compensation review through their manager or the confidential HR channel. The request should include role scope, outcomes, and market information where available.

Exceptions and guidance

A request starts a review; it does not guarantee an adjustment. Compensation decisions require budget and equity review.

Metadata: source=company_handbook.pdf | section=9 | version=2026.1 | status=current | owner=People Operations

10. Performance Management

Policy

Managers set goals at the beginning of the performance year and provide feedback throughout the year. Employees may request a feedback conversation at any time. Formal performance documentation is stored in the approved HR system.

Exceptions and guidance

Employees may ask HR to facilitate a review when they believe the process was not followed.

Metadata: source=company_handbook.pdf | section=10 | version=2026.1 | status=current | owner=People Operations

11. Recruiting and Internal Mobility

Policy

Open roles are posted in the internal careers portal. Employees may apply for roles when they meet the published requirements and have discussed the move with their manager. Interview information is confidential.

Exceptions and guidance

Hiring teams must use the approved applicant tracking system and follow fair hiring procedures.

Metadata: source=company_handbook.pdf | section=11 | version=2026.1 | status=current | owner=People Operations

12. Onboarding

Policy

New employees complete identity verification, employment forms, security training, and equipment setup during their first week. The hiring manager owns the onboarding checklist and HR owns the employment records.

Exceptions and guidance

Access to production systems requires completion of required training and manager approval.

Metadata: source=company_handbook.pdf | section=12 | version=2026.1 | status=current | owner=People Operations

13. Information Security

Policy

Employees must use company-managed devices and approved identity controls. Passwords, tokens, and recovery codes must never be shared. Suspected phishing, lost devices, or accidental disclosure must be reported through the security incident channel.

Exceptions and guidance

Security incidents are urgent and should not wait for a routine HR response.

Metadata: source=company_handbook.pdf | section=13 | version=2026.1 | status=current | owner=People Operations

14. Acceptable Use

Policy

Company systems are provided for work and limited personal use that does not create risk, cost, or disruption. Employees may not install unapproved software, bypass security controls, or upload company data to an unapproved service.

Exceptions and guidance

Security and Legal may place additional controls on regulated or customer data.

Metadata: source=company_handbook.pdf | section=14 | version=2026.1 | status=current | owner=People Operations

15. Workplace Conduct

Policy

The company expects respectful, inclusive, and professional conduct. Harassment, discrimination, retaliation, and threats are prohibited. Concerns may be reported to a manager, HR, Ethics, or the confidential reporting channel.

Exceptions and guidance

Reports are handled according to the investigation process and applicable law.

Metadata: source=company_handbook.pdf | section=15 | version=2026.1 | status=current | owner=People Operations

16. Conflicts of Interest

Policy

Employees must disclose outside work, gifts, investments, or relationships that could affect business decisions. The Compliance Team reviews disclosures and records any approved mitigation.

Exceptions and guidance

When in doubt, disclose the situation before accepting an assignment or gift.

Metadata: source=company_handbook.pdf | section=16 | version=2026.1 | status=current | owner=People Operations

17. Data Privacy

Policy

Personal information must be collected, accessed, and retained only for an approved business purpose. Employees should use the minimum necessary data and follow retention schedules.

Exceptions and guidance

Privacy questions should be routed to the Privacy Team. The HR assistant must not expose private records in a chat response.

Metadata: source=company_handbook.pdf | section=17 | version=2026.1 | status=current | owner=People Operations

18. Policy Ownership and Versions

Policy

Each policy has an owner, effective date, review date, and status. The current policy repository is authoritative. Archived policies remain available for audit but should not be used for current employee guidance.

Exceptions and guidance

The policy owner approves changes. The repository publishes a new version when a policy changes.

Metadata: source=company_handbook.pdf | section=18 | version=2026.1 | status=current | owner=People Operations

19. Exceptions and Escalation

Policy

An exception requires an approved owner, a reason, a scope, and an expiration date. Employees should use the escalation path named in the policy rather than asking the assistant to approve an exception.

Exceptions and guidance

The assistant may explain the process and create an authorized follow-up request, but a human owner makes the decision.

Metadata: source=company_handbook.pdf | section=19 | version=2026.1 | status=current | owner=People Operations

20. HR Service Levels

Policy

Routine policy questions received through the HR mailbox may take up to 24 hours for a first response. The proposed policy assistant is intended to provide a first grounded answer in seconds, twenty-four hours a day, while routing sensitive or unresolved cases to HR.

Exceptions and guidance

The assistant must cite evidence, state when evidence is insufficient, and preserve the human escalation path.

Metadata: source=company_handbook.pdf | section=20 | version=2026.1 | status=current | owner=People Operations